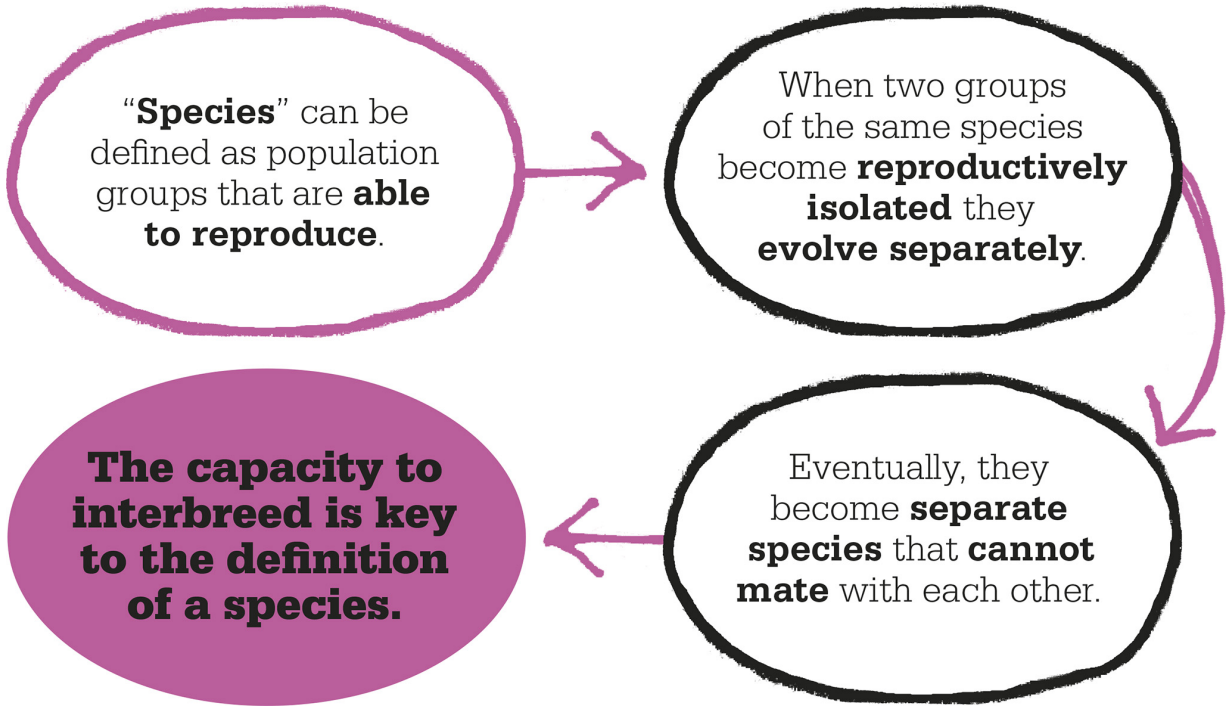
precisely what a “species” was. In 1942, evolutionary biologist Ernst Mayr proposed a new definition of species: groups of interbreeding natural populations that are “reproductively isolated from other such groups.”

What this means is that two populations of the same species living in the same area may at some point become separated by feeding strategies, geography, mate choice, or other means, and then begin to change through natural selection or genetic drift. Over time, as a result of this initial separation, two distinct species evolve, which cannot interbreed. This type of speciation commonly occurs in small populations of creatures on remote islands.



Read accessible description

Key differences

The biological species concept is primarily focused on the breeding potential between organisms. Two organisms may appear identical and live in the same place, but this does not mean that they are the same species. For